WHITE PAPER · HWACHEON HI-TECH 400 × AEROSPACE

Hwacheon Hi-Tech 400 for Aerospace

Mid-size CNC lathe with live tooling — turn, mill, drill, and thread in one setup. This paper covers what the machine does, the aerospace parts we produce with it, the alloys we run, the tolerances and finishes aerospace buyers expect, and the documentation package.

12.5" OD × 49" L max turning ENVELOPE	**±0.0005" routine on critical features** TOLERANCE	**1994** SINCE
Same-week / rig-down direct RESPONSE		



Torque & Tumble · 12.5" OD × 49" L max turning · mid-size CNC lathe with live tooling

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Executive summary

Machine: Hwacheon Hi-Tech 400 (shop nickname: *Torque & Tumble*). mid-size CNC lathe with live tooling at B&R Productions, running from our New Waverly, Texas shop.

Application: Mid-size CNC lathe with live tooling — turn, mill, drill, and thread in one setup for Aerospace customers — Aerospace primes, tier-1 and tier-2 suppliers, MRO shops, propulsion component manufacturers, structural assembly integrators, actuator OEMs.

Envelope: 12.5" OD × 49" L max turning. **Tolerance:** ±0.0005" routine on critical features. **Traceability:** Material by heat and lot on every job.

The machine, in context

The Hi-Tech 400 is Hwacheon's heavy-duty box-way turning platform — the class of lathe you reach for when you're taking real chips off tough alloys. The 15" hydraulic chuck and 5.3" spindle bore let it accept the kind of stock most job-shop lathes won't clear, and the box-way construction keeps roughing cuts stable in Inconel and Duplex. Torque & Tumble handles wellhead spools, downhole tool bodies, valve stems, and any oilfield turning where rigidity and bore size matter more than cycle time.

Why Torque & Tumble for Aerospace work

Aerospace turned parts carry milled features with position tolerances referenced to turned datums, and GD&T makes that relationship explicit rather than implied. Live tooling holds the relationship by never breaking the setup, which is a stronger answer than holding it across two machines and a fixture.

What this looks like on a real part

An actuator end cap with a sealing bore and a bolt pattern that must hold true position to that bore is the classic case. Two operations means the bolt pattern's position is only as good as the fixture that picked up the bore, and on a tight true-position callout the fixture becomes the tolerance. Turned and drilled in one chucking, the datum never moves. In 17-4 PH the additional care is condition: H900 and H1150 behave differently enough that the machining plan has to know which one is on the print before anyone cuts.

> **When this is the wrong machine**
>
> 1,800 RPM is a rigidity trade, and it shows on small-diameter aluminum aerospace work that wants speed. Driven-tool cuts also get lighter depths than the same feature on a VMC — a lathe turret is rigid for a lathe, not rigid like a BT50 column.

Full specifications

Model	Hwacheon Hi-Tech 400 ("Torque & Tumble")
Type	Heavy-duty box-way CNC turning center — Hi-Tech 400 platform
Max turning capacity	12.5" OD × 49" L (B&R working spec)
Platform Z travel	1,270 mm (50") on the Hi-Tech 400 platform
Platform X travel	280 mm (11")
Chuck	15" hydraulic (Hi-Tech 400 platform)
Spindle nose	A2-11; 135 mm (5.3") spindle bore
Spindle speed	1,800 RPM (heavy-duty configuration)
Spindle motor	28/30 kVA
Tailstock	Programmable hydraulic; MT-6 taper
Turret	12-station
Rapid traverse	24 m/min
Control	Fanuc 18iTB
Structure	Box-way construction for heavy roughing rigidity
Machine weight	~18,700 lb
Tolerance capability	±0.0005" routine on critical features
Materials	Stainless, carbon steel, Inconel, Duplex, 17-4 PH, Monel, aluminum

Values marked "platform" reflect the machine manufacturer's published spec range for this platform family; B&R's working spec is what we quote on this specific unit.

Who this serves in Aerospace

Typical buyer: Aerospace primes, tier-1 and tier-2 suppliers, MRO shops, propulsion component manufacturers, structural assembly integrators, actuator OEMs.

What's hard about aerospace work: Certification-driven documentation, exotic superalloys, tight tolerances on structural and engine components, and finding a job shop that understands aged-condition superalloys rather than learning on the part.

Typical Aerospace parts we produce on Torque & Tumble

- Aerospace parts combining turned surfaces with cross-holes or milled flats
- Actuator rods with keyways and drilled features
- Structural round parts requiring feature concentricity
- One-setup finished parts to minimize stack-up error
- Engine components with mixed turned + milled features

Above list is representative; if your part isn't shown, call and ask — most oilfield / aerospace / defense / industrial turned or milled work fits somewhere in the shop.

Alloys we run for Aerospace

Standard range: Titanium Grade 5 (Ti-6Al-4V) and Grade 23 (Ti-6Al-4V ELI) · Inconel 718 · Inconel 625 · Waspaloy · A286 · 17-4 PH · 15-5 PH · 13-8 Mo PH · Aluminum 7075/6061 · Custom aerospace alloys on request.

Titanium Grade 5 is the workhorse and it's temperature-sensitive: aggressive chip load with flood coolant keeps the heat in the chip, not the workpiece. Light cuts overheat titanium and cook tools; that's why titanium demands a different intuition than steel. Inconel 718 in aerospace-aged condition is harder and less forgiving than the annealed billet stock — most aerospace 718 work assumes aged. 17-4 PH and 15-5 PH are common for structural and actuator components; both are precipitation-hardening stainless with condition-specific machining plans.

> **What "we run these weekly" means:** we stock or reliably source the common alloys in the industry's typical spec range. Sharp tooling, proven feeds and speeds, and process control specific

> to each alloy family. Your part is not the one we're experimenting on.

How we machine it — our 5-step process

This is the process B&R runs on every job, aerospace or otherwise. The specifics of feeds, speeds, and tooling shift by alloy and machine; the discipline is universal.

1. **Material verification.** Every job starts with material traceability. Heat and lot numbers documented against the mill test report. For customer-supplied material, we verify against the CofC before touching the stock.

2. **First-article layout.** Stock is measured and laid out before any cutting starts. Concentricity, roundness, and squareness of the starting material established; if the stock is out of tolerance we call the customer before wasting time on a bad blank.

3. **Roughing with process control for the alloy.** Feeds, speeds, and coolant strategy set for the specific alloy family — sharp coated carbide (or PCD for high-volume Ti Grade 5), positive rake, high-pressure through-tool coolant on 2507 and Inconel to control cutting temperature. Interrupted cuts get extra attention because they cycle heat into the workpiece.

4. **Finish pass to spec.** Finish pass with a fresh insert, controlled DOC, and measured surface-finish targets. Critical features (bore concentricity, seat grooves, sealing surfaces) are held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer.

5. **CMM verification + documentation.** Every critical dimension CMM-verified. First-article report generated. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, tell us with the RFQ and we'll be straight about what we can and can't produce in-house.

Tolerance and finish expectations in Aerospace

±0.0005" routine on critical features. Tighter with proper fixture and setup — some aerospace features run ±0.0002" or GD&T-driven cylindricity and position tolerances. CMM verification standard on first articles; process-driven measurement on runs. Surface finish measured, not estimated.

Documentation and quality workflow

First-article layout and CMM verification standard. Material traceability by heat and lot. Certificates of conformance issued with delivery. Proprietary prints handled under NDA — prints stay in-shop and aren't sent to outside vendors. To be clear about what we are not: B&R is not AS9100-registered and not ITAR-registered. If your program requires either, you need a registered shop and we'll say so on the first call rather than after you've placed the order.

Response time and emergency work

AOG (aircraft-on-ground) work prioritized when material is available. Emergency response supported for existing aerospace customers with blanket arrangements or established relationships. Call direct at (936) 291-7827.

How we compare

Compared to a captive aerospace shop: we're faster for one-offs and small runs, more flexible on setup, and we don't require a long approval process. Compared to a lowest-bidder commodity shop: we understand the alloys and we treat first-article inspection as a discipline rather than a formality. Where a registered shop beats us is on programs that require AS9100 flow-down — we're the wrong call for those, and the right call for non-controlled work, prototypes, tooling, and MRO parts where alloy competence and turnaround matter more than a certificate on the wall.

Working with B&R Productions

New customer or existing, the process starts the same way: call (936) 291-7827 or send a print through the quote form. Prints are accepted as PDF, STEP, IGES, DWG, or DXF; if you only have a sample part, we reverse-engineer routinely. NDAs on request, and prints stay in-shop rather than going out to third-party vendors. Note for defense and aerospace buyers: B&R is not ITAR- or AS9100-registered, so export-controlled prints and AS9100 flow-down programs need a registered shop — we'll tell you that on the first call, not after the PO.

Quotes typically come back within 24 hours for standard work, same-day for repeat customers on stocked materials, and near-immediately by phone for emergency and rig-down situations. Lead times are quoted honestly — we don't promise Wednesday and deliver next month.

Frequently asked questions

8 questions covering the Hwacheon Hi-Tech 400 platform and Aerospace work. Also indexed as FAQ schema for AI answer engines.

What makes the Hi-Tech 400 different from a standard CNC lathe?

Box-way construction and a heavy-duty spindle assembly rated for real chips in tough alloys. 15" hydraulic chuck, 5.3" (135 mm) spindle bore, and a programmable hydraulic tailstock with MT-6 taper for long-part support.

What's the max turning length on the Hi-Tech 400?

B&R's working spec is 49" L × 12.5" OD. The platform Z-axis travel is 1,270 mm (50") — matching B&R's stated envelope.

What control does the Hi-Tech 400 run?

Fanuc 18iTB. 12-station turret, rapid traverse 24 m/min, machine weight ~18,700 lb.

Do you serve aerospace primes and tier-1/2 suppliers?

On work that doesn't require a registered QMS, yes — that's the honest boundary. B&R is not AS9100-registered, and where that matters it matters absolutely, so we say it before you spend time on an RFQ: if your program requires AS9100 flow-down, we're the wrong shop. Prototypes, tooling, fixtures, MRO and repair parts, and non-controlled components are where a shop like this is genuinely useful to a prime or a tier-1, and that's the work we'd like to quote.

Can you handle ITAR-controlled aerospace/defense work?

No. ITAR compliance requires registration with the U.S. State Department's DDTC, and B&R does not hold that registration. If your print is ITAR-controlled, you need a registered shop — send it elsewhere and we'd rather tell you now than after you've placed an order. Plenty of aerospace and defense work isn't export-controlled, and that work we quote gladly. Either way, proprietary prints are handled under NDA and stay in-shop.

What tolerances do you hold on aerospace parts?

±0.0005" routine on critical features. First-article layout and CMM verification standard. Surface-finish targets measured to spec.

What aerospace alloys do you run?

Titanium Grade 5 (Ti-6Al-4V), Grade 23 ELI, Inconel 718 and 625, Waspaloy, A286, 17-4 PH, 15-5 PH, aluminum 7075/6061. Custom aerospace alloys on request.

Can you respond to AOG (aircraft-on-ground) work?

Yes, when material is available. Emergency response supported for existing aerospace customers. Newer customers should call to discuss what's realistic for their specific alloy and part.

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Ready to talk about your Aerospace work?

Send us a print or a sample photo and specs. Emergencies: call direct and say "rig-down."

Published by B&R Productions — a precision CNC machining shop in New Waverly, Texas, in business since 1994. Serving oil & gas, aerospace, defense, and industrial customers across Texas and the Gulf Coast.

Written by the B&R Productions team. Machine specs verified against manufacturer data. Alloy and process notes reflect shop practice as of 2026-01-15.